



TUESDAY

SEPTEMBER 29, 2026
RABI AL THANI 18, 1448

TRUSTED NEWS SINCE 1978

GULF NEWS

gulfnews.com



LIVE
UPDATES

The Bridge To Your Home



Cargo, Courier,
Shipping, logistics

800 916
www.abccargo.com

31545865 1421



UAE Presidential Court

Sheikh Mohamed takes the train from Abu Dhabi to Dubai to attend the inauguration of the Etihad Rail station in Dubai yesterday.

MOHAMED TAKES A TRAIN RIDE AHEAD OF ETIHAD RAIL LAUNCH

HAMDAN, THEYAB INAUGURATE DUBAI STATION

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday travelled aboard an Etihad Rail train from Abu Dhabi to Dubai on a journey ahead of the official launch of the service on the national passenger rail network.

During the journey, Sheikh Mohamed reviewed Etihad Rail's operating system and its national objectives, as well as the quality of services provided to enhance the passenger experience in line with the highest international standards.

Later, in the presence of Sheikh Mohamed, Sheikh Hamdan bin Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Dubai Executive Council Chairman, and Sheikh Theyab bin Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Chairman of the Presidential Court for Development and Fallen Heroes' Affairs and Chairman of Etihad Rail, inaugurated the Etihad Rail station in Dubai, announcing the official launch of the national passenger rail network and the start of a new

phase of expansion connecting more cities and regions across the UAE.

The inauguration comes ahead of the start of services between Abu Dhabi, Dubai and Fujairah tomorrow.

During a tour of the station, Sheikh Hamdan, accompanied by Sheikh Theyab, reviewed its facilities,

Connecting the Emirate of Dubai to the national Etihad Rail network strengthens its position at the heart of the country's mobility network."

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed

services and operating systems, including advanced solutions and technologies designed to provide an integrated passenger experience, from arriving at the station and booking tickets to completing travel procedures, boarding the train and con-

tinuing to the final destination.

New national gateway

Sheikh Hamdan said the Etihad Rail station in Dubai adds a new national gateway that strengthens the emirate's links with the capital and other cities across the UAE, while supporting its urban and economic growth and global standing.

"Connecting the Emirate of Dubai to the national Etihad Rail network strengthens its position at the heart of the country's mobility network, supports its pivotal role in the national economy and reinforces its status as a global centre for business, tourism and investment," Sheikh Hamdan said.

"It also adds to Dubai's infrastructure a national transport network that improves accessibility to and from the emirate and keeps pace with its growth and future ambitions."

From tomorrow, Etihad Rail will enable travel between Abu Dhabi, Dubai and Fujairah. Tickets are available through the Etihad Rail app, website and ticket machines at stations, with fares starting at Dh39 for Comfort Class and Dh109 for Premium Class.

SEE ALSO P4

Global stocks falter as oil stays high

US, Asian market investors fight uncertainty as oil raises inflation risks

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE

Your Money Editor

Global stock markets came under pressure yesterday as oil prices climbed above \$106 a barrel, raising fresh concerns about inflation and interest rates.

US stocks fell, with the Dow Jones Industrial Average dropping 377 points, or 0.7 per cent. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq Composite both declined 0.5 per cent as higher oil prices and borrowing costs weighed on investors.

Alarming, US Treasury yields also remained high, with the yield on the 10-year bonds trading above 5.2 per cent. In simple terms, this is the return investors receive for lending money to the US government. When that return rises, loans can become more expensive for households and businesses, while some investors may prefer government bonds over shares.

Among Asian markets, South Korea's Kospi fell 2.3 per cent, while China's Shanghai Com-

posite dropped 1.7 per cent. Japan's Nikkei 225 was little changed, while Australia's S&P/ASX 200 gained 0.3 per cent and Hong Kong's Hang Seng rose 0.7 per cent.

Brent Crude rises over 2%

Oil prices were again a major focus. Brent crude rose more than 2 per cent to \$106.79 a barrel, while US crude climbed to around \$94.40. Prices remain volatile because of uncertainty over the Iran war and when oil will be able to flow more freely through the Strait of Hormuz.

Brent had briefly fallen to around \$97 last week, helping US stocks recover. Wall Street ended Friday higher and completed its first winning week in three.

Higher oil prices can make fuel, transport and other goods more expensive, keeping inflation elevated. That could encourage the US Federal Reserve to keep interest rates high or raise them again.

Investors will now watch US inflation data tomorrow, manufacturing figures on Thursday and the September jobs report on Friday for clues about what the Federal Reserve may do next. These reports could influence markets around the world again.

SEE ALSO P6, P1

IN FOCUS

Why women need to question online hormone content | P8-9

SPORT

Mariam Kareem wins first gold medal for the UAE at Asian Games | P16



Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com

www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions

Tel: 600 587 234

E mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00 Bahrain: BD 0.500 Oman: RO 0.500 India: Rs 40.00 S.Arabia: SR 5.00 Pakistan: Rs 100.00

Pakistan ends machine-readable passports

Shift to e-passports will be completed on October 15

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED

Managing Editor

Pakistan is ending the issuance of machine-readable passports (MRPs) from October 15, 2026, completing its transition to e-passports for new applicants at home and abroad. For overseas Pakistanis, in-

cluding those living in UAE and other Gulf countries, e-passports will become the standard Pakistani travel document for new applications. Applicants should follow announcements from the Pakistani embassy or consulate serving their country for details on application procedures, fees, processing times and local implementation of the e-passport system.

An e-passport is an electronic passport containing a chip that stores passport and identity information.

The electronic component can be read by compatible immigration systems, allowing identity and passport information to be electronically verified.

Pakistan has already been introducing e-passports, but the October 15 deadline marks the end of issuing the older machine-readable version.

The government says the move is part of efforts to modernise the country's passport system and facilitate international travel.

SEE ALSO P10

راحتك مسؤوليتنا
YOUR COMFORT, OUR RESPONSIBILITY

ENGINEERED FOR POWER. BUILT TO LAST. DESIGNED FOR ELEGANCE.

Stay cool with Generaltec, backed by 25 years of trusted comfort and reliable performance. Delivering peace of mind in every breath of fresh air.

@generaltec_ www.generaltec.com
AJMAN 068812883 SHARJAH 065300505 DUBAI 042202247 ABU DHABI 024911388

31546026_21